$$T_1 - T_2 = \frac{mv_1^2}{r} + mg - \left(\frac{mv_2^2}{r} - mg\right)$$

$$= \frac{mv_1^2}{r} + mg - \frac{mv_2^2}{r} + mg$$

$$T_1 - T_2 = \frac{m}{r}\left[v_1^2 - v_2^2\right] + 2mg \qquad (4.34)$$

The term $\left[v_1^2 - v_2^2\right]$ can be found easily by applying law of conservation of energy at point 1 and also at point 2.

Note

The tension will not do any work on the mass as the tension and the direction of motion is always perpendicular.

The gravitational force is doing work on the mass, as it is a conservative force the total energy of the mass is conserved throughout the motion.

Total Energy at point 1(E_1) is same as the total energy at a point 2 (E_2)

$$E_1 = E_2 \qquad (4.35)$$

Potential Energy at point 1, $U_1 = 0$ (by taking reference as point 1)

Kinetic Energy at point 1, $KE_1 = \frac{1}{2}mv_1^2$

Total Energy at point 1, $E_1 = U_1 + KE_1 = = 0 + \frac{1}{2}mv_1^2 = \frac{1}{2}mv_1^2$

Similarly, Potential Energy at point 2, $U_2 = mg\,(2r)$ (h is 2r from point 1)

Kinetic Energy at point 2, $KE_2 = \frac{1}{2}mv_2^2$

Total Energy at point 2, $E_2 = U_2 + KE_2 = 2\,mg\,r + \frac{1}{2}mv_2^2$

From the law of conservation of energy given in equation (4.35), we get

$$\frac{1}{2}mv_1^2 = 2mgr + \frac{1}{2}mv_2^2$$

After rearranging,

$$\frac{1}{2}m\left(v_1^2 - v_2^2\right) = 2mgr$$

$$v_1^2 - v_2^2 = 4gr \qquad (4.36)$$

Substituting equation (4.36) in equation (4.34) we get,

$$T_1 - T_2 = \frac{m}{r}\left[4gr\right] + 2mg$$

Therefore, the difference in tension is

$$T_1 - T_2 = 6\ mg \qquad (4.37)$$

Minimum speed at the highest point (2)

The body must have a minimum speed at point 2 otherwise, the string will slack before reaching point 2 and the body will not loop the circle. To find this minimum speed let us take the tension T_2 = 0 in equation (4.33).

$$0 = \frac{mv_2^2}{r} - mg$$

$$\frac{mv_2^2}{r} = mg$$

$$v_2^{\ 2} = rg$$

$$v_2 = \sqrt{gr} \qquad (4.38)$$

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